POC Learning Lab — The Business Case

Three agent patterns an executive can inspect before funding anything.

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Honesty note: the Day 1 notebooks are scripted demonstrations over synthetic data, labelled ILLUSTRATIVE in the repository. The measured-pilot standard is slide 7.

Why agents fail in business — it is rarely the model

- Claims nobody can trace — a vision agent asserts; nobody can check where it looked.
- State nobody can audit — work happens in side channels; the audit is a reconstruction.
- Behaviour nobody contracted — scope invented at runtime, outputs downstream cannot consume, runs that never cleanly end.

The lab's three patterns are the cheapest known controls for exactly these three failures — each one small, runnable, and public.

Pattern 1 · Grounded perception + verification (POC 01)

Flow: scene → claims (region + confidence) → flag rule → verification → survival rate.

The money: unverified automation is rework with a latency period. The survival rate prices human touch BEFORE scale.

Insurance & field services — photo claims triage, damage assessment.

Construction & facilities — site-inspection QA. Retail — shelf/signage audits.

Public sector — accessibility audits of public spaces (the demo's case).

Pattern 2 · The transcript is the system of record (POC 02)

Flow: Analyst ↔️ transcript ↔️ Executor — no side channels; findings and replay read from the transcript alone.

The money: coordination failures are provenance failures. A transcript-of-record removes reconstruction cost from every audit, dispute and incident review.

Contact centres — agent-assist wrap-up, QA sampling, complaints.

Finance operations — reconciliations with a full trail. Healthcare admin — auditable case coordination.

Shared services / BPO — any workflow where the client may say: show me.

Pattern 3 · Contract before capability — RODS (POC 03)

Flow: four-line contract → linter → run → typed completion signal → termination on the signal.

The money: agent incidents are contract incidents. Four lines and a checker price the risk BEFORE deployment — the cheapest control in this field.

Telecom & utilities — regulated operations, SLA extraction.

Banking & insurance — document extraction with explicit do-nots.

Legal operations — clause and obligation extraction (the demo's case). Any enterprise — as the intake gate for internal agents.

The concepts on one screen

01 SEE: scene → claims + confidence → flag → verify → SURVIVAL RATE

02 TALK: Analyst ↔️ TRANSCRIPT (the record) ↔️ Executor → findings · replay · audit

03 RODS: contract → LINT → run → typed signal → clean termination

Full diagrams (Mermaid, rendered on GitHub): diagrams/CONCEPT-DIAGRAMS.md in the repository.

From demonstration to deployment — four steps

1 · Pattern fit (days) — name the owner and the cost line the pattern moves. No pattern, no project.

2 · Measured pilot (weeks) — one site, one workflow, human checkers; illustrative metrics become measured ones against a recorded baseline.

3 · Contract & controls (weeks) — RODS contracts on every agent, transcript-of-record on, verification loop staffed.

4 · Scale decision — expand only on the measured pilot numbers. The same evidence discipline this repo is published under.

The lean start

The reference implementations are free (MIT code / CC BY 4.0 text) and run offline — inspect them before any meeting.

Step 2's real cost is people-time: one business owner, one engineer, checker hours for the verification loop.

Evidence first. Platform spend after the numbers exist.

Repository: github.com/GAI-Engineering/poc-learning-lab — business case: business/BUSINESS-CASE.md